

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Results chain of every IR answer

INTEREST -> security, growth, resources, technology, diaspora, reputation, autonomy
-> EXTERNAL CONTEXT / ACTOR: neighbour, major power, region, grouping, institution
-> INSTRUMENT: bilateral visit, regional forum, minilateral coalition, multilateral platform
-> VERIFIED OUTCOME: joint statement, agreement, charter, declaration, memorandum
-> CONSTRAINT: asymmetry, rival-power competition, partner politics, capacity limits
-> CALIBRATED WAY FORWARD: diversify, hedge, sequence, build alternative capacity
MUST REMEMBER: Indian foreign policy converts constitutional values, national interests,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Three labels, one continuing principle

NON-ALIGNMENT -> no bloc alliance, independent approach, friendly relations with all
-> STRATEGIC AUTONOMY: multipolar-era label for issue-by-issue freedom of choice
-> MULTI-ALIGNMENT: every relevant platform engaged on its own terms, non-exclusively
CONSTANT -> independent, interest-based decision-making survives every relabelling

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Posture vocabulary grid

BANDWAGONING -> align with the stronger power and accept its agenda

BALANCING -> align against the stronger power to check it

HEDGING -> engage and mitigate risk with more than one power at the same time

NEUTRALITY -> equidistance or non-participation; expressly not India's posture

RULE -> hedging is active and asymmetric, so it is never fence-sitting

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Panchsheel card

INSTRUMENT -> preamble of the India-China Agreement on Trade and Intercourse with the Tibet Region of China, signed 29 April 1954

PRINCIPLE 1 -> mutual respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity

PRINCIPLE 2 -> non-aggression PRINCIPLE 3 -> non-interference

PRINCIPLE 4 -> equality and mutual benefit PRINCIPLE 5 -> peaceful coexistence

BOUNDARY -> a normative-principles statement, not the non-alignment posture

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Five levels of engagement

BILATERAL -> summit visit, joint statement, defence or trade agreement

REGIONAL -> SAARC, BIMSTEC, IORA, India-Central Asia Dialogue

MINILATERAL -> Quad, I2U2, RIC, IBSA; small, issue-specific, non-treaty

MULTILATERAL -> United Nations, World Trade Organization, IMF, World Bank, G20

DIASPORA -> Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, ITEC, consular and welfare diplomacy

NOTE -> one issue is frequently worked at more than one level at the same time

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Evidentiary ladder of instruments

TREATY / AGREEMENT -> binding once ratified

CHARTER -> binding on member states once in force

JOINT STATEMENT / VISION -> political commitment, not a treaty

DECLARATION -> political or normative, not legally binding

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING -> statement of intent, not self-executing

CORRIDOR MEMORANDUM -> framework of intent, not an operating segment

PARTNER / OBSERVER STATUS -> participation without membership rights and duties

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Declared-vision timeline

12 MARCH 2015 -> SAGAR articulated in Mauritius: Security and Growth for All in the Region
12-13 JANUARY 2023 -> first Voice of Global South Summit, convened virtually by India
17 NOVEMBER 2023 -> second Voice of Global South Summit
17 AUGUST 2024 -> third Voice of Global South Summit; no fourth recorded as of 3 August 2026
12 MARCH 2025 -> MAHASAGAR announced at Port Louis as going beyond SAGAR
STATUS -> declared visions and convened platforms, not treaties or delivered programmes

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Hedging stress test of 2025-26

27 AUGUST 2025 -> additional Russian-oil-linked United States duty takes effect
4 AND 6 AUGUST 2025 -> India officially calls the action unjustified and unreasonable
31 OCTOBER 2025 -> ten-year Framework for the US-India Major Defense Partnership signed
4-5 DECEMBER 2025 -> twenty-third India-Russia Annual Summit held in New Delhi
7 FEBRUARY 2026 -> the additional duty is removed
READING -> hedging held, but its cost was real, priced and third-party imposed

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Autonomy-dependence trade-off

PORTFOLIO -> overlapping, non-exclusive ties with several powers protect choice

THRESHOLD -> deepening any one tie too far narrows the choice it was meant to protect

SIKRI CAUTION -> enmeshing military planning while heavily dependent on Russian equipment
is called highly debatable absent reciprocal technology-sharing

ANSWER RULE -> concede the trade-off; do not assert that autonomy is costless

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Energy exposure as vulnerability and lever

LEVER -> a Gulf diaspora of five million gives vital interests and considerable influence

VULNERABILITY -> crude-oil import dependence recorded at 88.2 per cent in FY2024-25

PROVISIONAL -> about 88.7 per cent provisional for FY2025-26 per the same issuing body

DISCIPLINE -> carry issuing body, financial year and provisional status with every figure

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Non-alignment is a historically situated policy, strategic autonomy is...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Recurring analytical gaps applied here

ANNOUNCEMENT-DELIVERY -> a memorandum or vision treated as a completed outcome

LEGAL-STATUS -> signature treated as ratification, or adoption as entry into force

MEMBERSHIP-PARTICIPATION -> partner or observer status described as membership

ALLIANCE-AUTONOMY -> a deepened partnership described as bloc membership

SANCTIONS-OBLIGATION -> another state's unilateral measure treated as a duty on India

FIX -> name the exact stage and its date before making any evaluative claim

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Separate strategic objective,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a foundations demand

OPEN -> state the continuing principle before naming any era-specific label

BUILD -> trace anti-colonial formation, bloc avoidance, diversification, multi-alignment

TEST -> cite one dated instrument with its exact evidentiary level and its actor

CLOSE -> concede the autonomy-dependence trade-off and give a calibrated way forward